



Wireless Headphones

It isn't how you think it was... It's pure sonic bliss

The sky is the limit when it comes to audio products. No amount of tuning done to the drivers of a pair of headphones or speakers can make them a one-size-fits-all kind of product. However, the closer the brand can get to giving the people buying them worth for their money, which includes excellent design and build and a well-rounded sound signature, the better its chances to make something that earns them a reputation for being the best the business. From the outside, it is hard to gauge why a brand is charging three times as much as its competitors when, on paper, their products come pretty close. You have to use it to believe it. When the testing was over, the results were pretty self-explanatory.

Winner and Best Buy: JBL Tour One M2

The JBL Tour One M2 was one of the rare products that bagged both the Digit Zero1 and Best Buy Awards in its category this year. With the JBL Tour One M2, you get a typical V-shaped sound signature out of the box. The mids come close to our baseline reading of the flat response recorded using Pink Noise, while there was a boost in the highs and the lows to make up for any lost detail in sound in those frequencies. The bass on JBL products is on the heavier side for the most part. However, with the Tour One M2, my experience with the headset was fairly well-rounded. There was a very nice thump to the sound. Even at max volume, there wasn't any distortion, and the microphone also handled every scenario I put it through with ease and grace. There were a couple of instances like in very noisy areas where there was a bit of background noise that seeped in. Their ANC, too, was better than any

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



JBL Tour One M2
Price: ₹24,999



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other headphones that showed up at the Test Centre this year, as they managed to drown out almost every background noise, apart from sudden shrill noises, which on some occasions seeped through. In our battery life test, the JBL Tour One M2 clocked in 28 hours, which added to its tally. When it came to the Best Buy Awards, over here as well, the headphones shined through with their excellent and comfortable build. I would have loved if JBL had added support for LDAC or aptX over LC3 and LC3+ because of their much wider adoption across the industry. With that said, the JBL Tour One M2 made an excellent case for themselves, despite their hefty price tag, becoming the winner of the Digit Best Buy Award 2023.

Runner Up: Sonic Lamb Headphones

The new kid on the block, the Sonic Lamb Headphones, impressed me immensely when I tested them. Because the frequency reproduction workload had been split between two distinct drivers, the sound signature as recorded by our test rig was very close to our target flat response. However, as I had prefaced in the intro, with audio, you have to use it to believe it. So, when I got to using these headphones, while the representation of bass and the mids and the highs was accurate, there was a separation between the bass and the other two frequencies, which I could not wrap my head around. The staging and the separation were immaculate. The passive isolation on these headphones is great. But, the lack of ANC pulled these headphones back by a decent margin. The mic was great, and the distortion or the lack thereof, when I maxed out the volume, was something that helped these headphones secure the runner-up spot.



Sonic Lamb Headphones
Price: ₹15,999

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